

## Pricing, Payment, Budgeting, and Proposals

### Technical & Financial Proposal

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#### 1. Selected Freelance Project

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| Project Link / Brief | <p><b>Platform:</b> Mostaql (mostaql.com) — <b>project title:</b> “تطبيق .NET Core” (“ .NET Core Application”).</p> <p>Link: <a href="https://mostaql.com/project/1227806">https://mostaql.com/project/1227806</a></p> <p>Posted budget: \$250 – \$500 (USD). Delivery method: remote, through the platform.</p> <p><b>Short copy of the client brief (summarised in English):</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>– The client owns a working web application built with ASP.NET WebForms and VB.NET, roughly 30 pages.</li><li>– He needs a developer with solid experience to maintain the system, improve it, and prepare it so it can later be converted to .NET Core with C#.</li><li>– Required skills listed: ASP.NET WebForms, VB.NET, .NET Core and C#, HTML/CSS/JavaScript, Microsoft SQL Server and APIs.</li><li>– <b>The client explicitly asks every bidder to send a proposal that states the duration, the cost, and previous work.</b></li></ul> <p><i>Why I chose it: it matches my specialisation as a backend .NET / C# developer, the scope is bounded enough to price with confidence, and the client is asking for exactly the kind of technical + financial proposal covered in this session.</i></p> |
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#### 2. Technical Proposal

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| Client Need          | <p>Reading the brief, the real need behind the request is not “write code” — it is risk control over an ageing system:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>– The current WebForms / VB.NET application is in production and the business depends on it, so it cannot be stopped or rewritten from scratch in one step.</li><li>– The client needs the existing system stabilised now: bugs fixed, slow pages made faster, and obvious security weaknesses closed.</li><li>– At the same time he wants a realistic and costed path to .NET Core (C#) later, instead of an open-ended migration with an unknown bill.</li><li>– He also needs certainty before he commits: a clear duration, a clear price, and proof that the developer can read and understand someone else's legacy code.</li></ul> <p><i>My understanding of the priority: protect the running system first, then produce a documented migration plan so the client can decide on Phase 2 with real numbers in front of him. Migrating 30 legacy pages blindly inside a \$500 budget would be dishonest to both sides — so this proposal covers Phase 1 only, and quotes Phase 2 after the audit.</i></p> |
| Scope & Deliverables | <p><b>In scope — Phase 1: Stabilise &amp; Prepare</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |

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|                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Code and database audit of the existing application: inventory of the ~30 pages, business rules, stored procedures, external/third-party dependencies and .NET Framework version.</li> <li>- Bug fixing and improvements: up to 12 items agreed with the client from a written, prioritised backlog.</li> <li>- Security pass: replacing dynamic SQL with parameterised queries / stored procedures, input validation, authentication and session review, and error-handling cleanup.</li> <li>- Performance pass on the 5 slowest pages: slow query tuning, indexing suggestions, and removal of redundant database round-trips.</li> <li>- Refactoring: moving business logic out of the page code-behind into a separate class library, so the same logic can be reused by the future .NET 8 application instead of being rewritten.</li> <li>- Migration readiness report: component-by-component compatibility matrix, recommended target architecture (ASP.NET Core MVC + Web API + EF Core + SQL Server), identified risks, and a phased migration plan with an effort estimate for Phase 2.</li> </ul> <p><b>Deliverables</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Updated, working source code pushed to the client's Git repository, with clear commit history.</li> <li>- Database change scripts (idempotent, with rollback notes).</li> <li>- Audit &amp; Migration Readiness Report (PDF, 8–12 pages, English or Arabic as the client prefers).</li> <li>- Short technical documentation of the refactored business-logic layer.</li> <li>- One recorded handover session (up to 60 minutes) walking the client's team through the changes.</li> </ul> <p><b>Out of scope (to protect both sides from scope creep)</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- The full migration of the application to .NET Core — this is Phase 2 and is quoted separately after the audit.</li> <li>- New features, new modules, or a UI/UX redesign.</li> <li>- Mobile application, hosting, domain, server administration, and any third-party licences.</li> <li>- Content entry, data migration from other systems, and ongoing monthly maintenance.</li> </ul> <p><b>Any request outside this list is handled by a written change request and a separate quotation before any work starts.</b></p> |
| <p><b>Timeline</b></p> | <p><b>Total duration: 4 weeks (20 working days), starting the day after access is granted.</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Week 1 (days 1–5): access setup, full code and database audit, prioritised bug/improvement backlog agreed in writing. → Milestone 1</li> <li>- Weeks 2–3 (days 6–15): bug fixing and improvements, security pass, performance pass, refactoring of business logic into the shared class library, deployment to staging. → Milestone 2</li> <li>- Week 4 (days 16–20): regression testing, Migration Readiness Report, documentation, handover session and Phase 2 quotation. → Milestone 3</li> </ul> <p><b>Assumptions the timeline depends on</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |

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|  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Repository access, a database dump, and a staging environment are provided on day 1.</li> <li>- Client feedback on any deliverable arrives within 48 hours; delays beyond that shift the schedule day for day.</li> <li>- Up to 2 rounds of revisions per deliverable are included.</li> <li>- Communication through the platform's message board, plus one 30-minute call per week.</li> </ul> |
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### 3. Financial Proposal

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| Price & Pricing Method | <p><b>Total price for Phase 1: \$480 USD, fixed price.</b></p> <p><b>Pricing method: fixed price, built bottom-up from an hourly estimate</b></p> <p>The client wants budget certainty and the scope above is bounded and written down, so a fixed price is the right model. To make sure that fixed number is realistic instead of a guess, I estimated the effort task by task at an internal rate of \$12/hour:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Code &amp; database audit + backlog: 8 hours = \$96</li> <li>- Bug fixing and improvements (12 items): 14 hours = \$168</li> <li>- Security pass: 5 hours = \$60</li> <li>- Performance pass (5 pages): 3 hours = \$36</li> <li>- Refactoring into a shared class library: 6 hours = \$72</li> <li>- Migration Readiness Report, documentation &amp; handover: 4 hours = \$48</li> <li>- <b>Total: 40 hours × \$12/hour = \$480 (inside the client's posted \$500 budget).</b></li> </ul> <p><b>Rates for anything beyond this scope</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Additional approved work: \$15/hour, billed only after written approval.</li> <li>- Phase 2 (full migration to ASP.NET Core / C#): quoted after the audit. Indicative range based on a 30-page WebForms application: \$1,800 – \$2,500, to be confirmed by the Migration Readiness Report.</li> </ul> <p><i>Note: the platform commission and any transfer fees are already absorbed in the price above, so the client pays \$480 and nothing else.</i></p> |
| Payment Terms          | <p><b>Contracting and payment go through the Mostaqi escrow service (الضمان) — the client's money is protected until each milestone is accepted, and my work is protected against non-payment.</b></p> <p><b>Payment schedule (milestone-based)</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- 30% — \$144 — funded into escrow before work begins; released on delivery of the audit report and the agreed backlog (Milestone 1).</li> <li>- 40% — \$192 — released on delivery of the fixed, refactored and secured build to the staging environment (Milestone 2).</li> <li>- 30% — \$144 — released on delivery of the Migration Readiness Report, documentation and handover session (Milestone 3).</li> </ul> <p><b>Conditions</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Acceptance window: 5 days per milestone. If no written feedback is received in that window, the milestone is considered accepted.</li> <li>- Warranty: 14 days of free bug fixing after final delivery, covering defects in the delivered work only — not new requirements.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |

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|  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- Out-of-scope work is never started before a written change request and an approved quotation.</li><li>- Intellectual property of the delivered source code transfers to the client on receipt of the final payment.</li><li>- Cancellation: if the client cancels mid-project, work completed up to that date is billable pro-rata based on the milestone breakdown above.</li><li>- Prices are valid for 14 days from the date of this proposal.</li></ul> |
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